

Thatcher and Major (1979–1997)

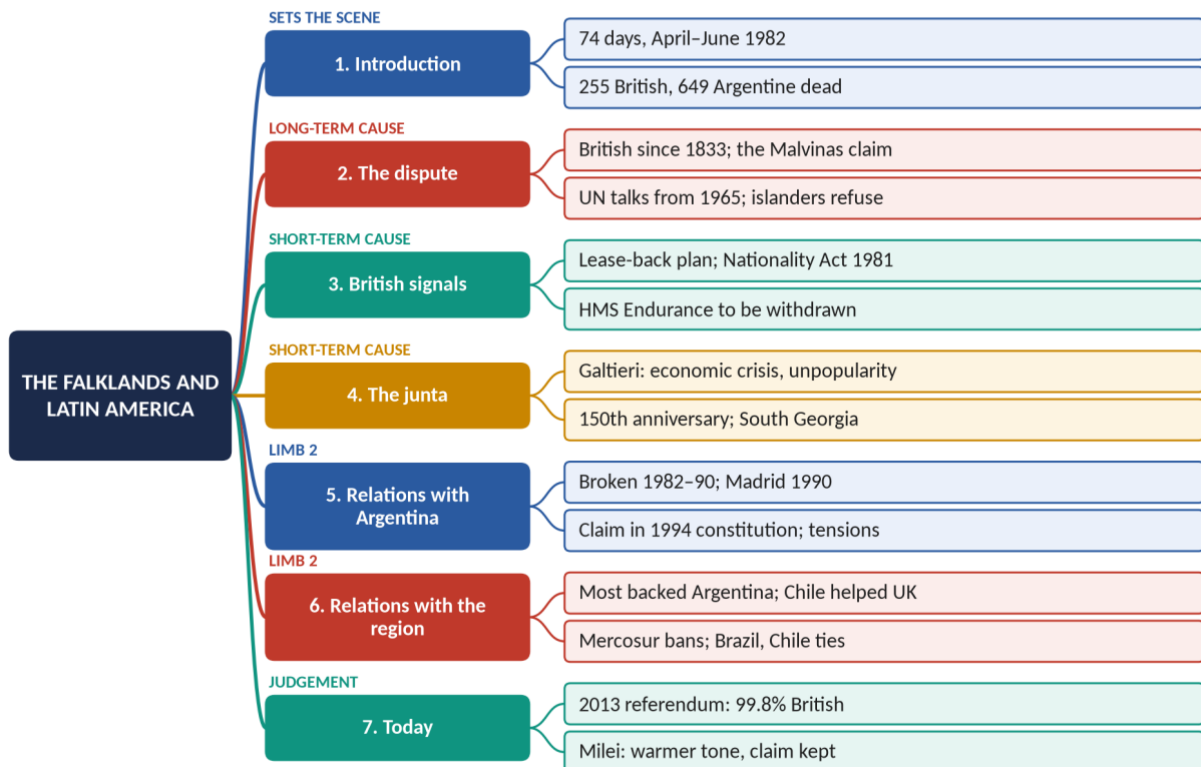
Every past question on Thatcher, the Falklands, John Major and Britain and Europe — answered in full, in simple words, with answer maps

ANSWER MAP • CSS 2020 • Q8 • SECTION B (ALSO 2022 • Q6)

What were the causes of the Falkland War? In what way has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?

KEY WORDS “causes” • “Falkland War” • “relationship with Latin American countries”

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Causes — long-term (the sovereignty dispute) and short-term (1980–82). (2) Effects on relations with Latin America — Argentina and the region, from 1982 to today.



VERDICT

The war grew from an old sovereignty dispute that British neglect and an unpopular Argentine junta turned into invasion; it poisoned Anglo-Argentine relations for years and still shapes Britain's place in Latin America.

All 11 past items (2015–2026): seven full answers, one repeat shown with its adaptation, and **three short notes**; the **four past MCQs** solved; **five predicted questions** with outlines.

Topic 9 of 10 · companion to T9KB (the Knowledge Base)

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How to Use These Answers

#	Paper	Question (short)	Answer
1	2016 Q6	"Thatcher the best post-war Prime Minister" — discuss	Answer 1
2	2024 Q5	Define Thatcherism; her economic and educational reforms and their impact	Answer 2
3	2020 Q8	Causes of the Falklands War; effect on relations with Latin America	Answer 3
4	2022 Q6	The same question as 2020 — how to reuse Answer 3	Answer 4
5	2021 Q6	What was the Falklands conflict; why Britain fought; how it ended	Answer 5
6	2019 Q8	Why Major won in 1992 but lost in 1997	Answer 6
7	2021 Q7	Britain's contribution to the Common Market and EU; impact on foreign policy	Answer 7
8	2026 Q6	European integration and British politics and identity since 1973	Answer 8
9	2018 Q8(b)	Short note: Britain's role in the EU	Short note
10	2024 Q7(a)	Short note: the Falklands War	Short note
11	2026 Q8(c)	Short note: John Major's foreign policy	Short note

Every answer has: the question as set · its **answer map** · **decoding the question** · a **model answer** with numbered headings, figures and a verdict · **why this answer scores**.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · The Falklands, four ways

Causes and Latin America (2020, 2022 — identical), **what, why and how it ended** (2021), and a **short note** (2024). The facts are in T9KB Chapter 2; the headings must come from each question.

Answer 1 · Thatcher: The Best Post-War Prime Minister?

THE QUESTION · CSS 2016 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

'Margaret Thatcher is judged to be the best post-war Prime Minister of England.'
Discuss.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2016 · Q6 · SECTION B

'Margaret Thatcher is judged to be the best post-war Prime Minister of England.' Discuss.

KEY WORDS "best post-war Prime Minister" · "Discuss"

IT DEMANDS Set out the case for and against, and compare her with the other main contender(s) — above all Attlee. Give criteria for "best" and a clear judgement.

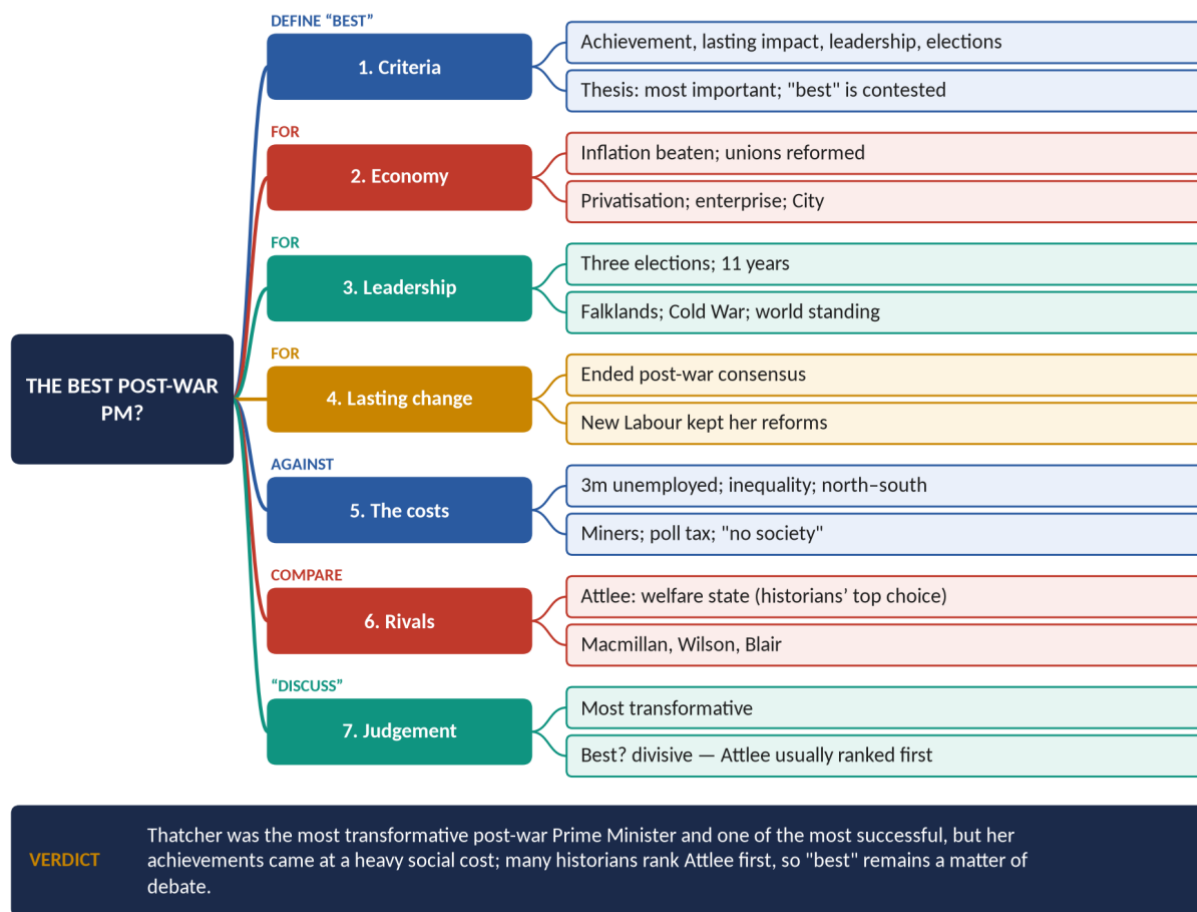


Figure 1 · The answer map for CSS 2016 · Q6 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"Discuss" a claim: give the **case for** and the **case against**, **compare** Thatcher with other post-war Prime Ministers (especially **Attlee**), set **criteria** for "best", and end with a clear judgement. "Post-war" = since **1945**.

The model answer

Introduction

Margaret Thatcher, Prime Minister from **1979 to 1990**, was Britain's first woman Prime Minister, the longest-serving of the twentieth century, and the only one whose name became an "-ism". Her admirers call her the **best** post-war Prime Minister; her critics call her the most **divisive**. Judged by **achievement**, **lasting impact**, **leadership** and **electoral success**, she has a strong claim to be the most **important** and **transformative** post-war leader. Whether she was the **best** is more doubtful: her gains came at a heavy social cost, and most historians place **Clement Attlee** first.

(1) The criteria for "best"

1. What did the Prime Minister **achieve**?
2. How **lasting** were the changes?
3. How strong was the **leadership**, at home and abroad?
4. How successful **electorally**?
5. At what **cost**?

The case for

(2) She reversed Britain's decline

- In **1979** Britain was the "**sick man of Europe**": inflation, strikes (the Winter of Discontent), loss-making state industries.
- **Inflation** fell from about **22 per cent** (1980) to under **5 per cent** (1983).
- **Union reform** (1980, 1982, 1984) and the defeat of the **miners' strike** (1984–85) ended the strikes that had brought down two governments.
- **Privatisation** (BT, British Gas, British Airways, water) and the **Big Bang** (1986) created a more efficient, enterprising economy; London became a world financial centre.
- **Tax cuts**: the top rate of income tax fell from **83** to **40 per cent**.

(3) She widened ownership

- **Right to Buy (1980)**: over a million council tenants bought their homes; home ownership rose to about two-thirds.
- **Shareholders** rose from about **3** to about **11 million**.

(4) Leadership and electoral success

- **Three general election victories** (1979, 1983, 1987) and **11½ years** in office — the longest continuous term since **1827**.
- **Conviction and courage**: "**The lady's not for turning**"; she survived the **Brighton bomb** (1984).

(5) World stature

- **The Falklands** (1982): she retook the islands and restored national pride.
- **The Cold War**: Reagan's closest ally; she saw in **Gorbachev** a man to "do business" with, helping to end the Cold War peacefully.
- **Europe**: the **budget rebate** (1984); the **single market** (1986).

(6) Lasting impact

She ended the **post-war consensus** and created a new one: **Tony Blair's** New Labour kept privatisation, the union laws and low income taxes. No other post-war PM, except Attlee, changed Britain so permanently.

The case against

(7) The social cost

- **Unemployment** over **3 million** for five years (1982–87); whole industrial communities destroyed — coal, steel, shipbuilding.
- **Inequality** rose faster than in almost any other developed country; poverty grew; a **north–south divide**.
- **Riots** (Brixton, Toxteth, 1981) and the bitterness of the **miners' strike**.
- "**There is no such thing as society**" (1987) seemed to sum up a selfish age.

(8) Mistakes

- **The poll tax** (1989–90) — unfair and unworkable; riots.
- **Economic mismanagement** at the end: the Lawson boom, inflation back to 10 per cent, 15 per cent interest rates.
- **Housing**: council houses sold but not replaced.
- **Manufacturing** neglected in favour of finance.

(9) Division

She divided the nation (the north v the south, Scotland v England) and her own party — her hostility to Europe led to the resignations of **Lawson** and **Howe** and to her fall (**1990**) at the hands of her own cabinet.

Comparison with other post-war Prime Ministers

Prime Minister	Claim to be "best"
Attlee (1945–51)	Built the welfare state and NHS, freed India, founded NATO — usually ranked first by historians.
Churchill (1951–55)	Great as a war leader; less so in peacetime.
Macmillan (1957–63)	Prosperity; decolonisation; restored the US alliance.
Wilson (1964–70, 1974–76)	Social reforms; won four elections.
Thatcher (1979–90)	Transformed the economy; three victories; Falklands; Cold War.
Blair (1997–2007)	Three victories; Northern Ireland peace; but Iraq.

Surveys of historians and political scientists (for example **2004, 2010, 2016**) usually put **Attlee first** and **Thatcher second**.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Thatcher has a powerful claim to be the most important and transformative post-war Prime Minister: she defeated inflation and union power, remade the economy, won three elections and the Falklands War, and changed British politics so deeply that her opponents kept her reforms. But her success came at a heavy price in unemployment, inequality and division, and she ended her career rejected by her own party. "Best" therefore remains contested: she was the most transformative, but most historians still give first place to Attlee, whose welfare state was built with less division.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It sets **criteria** for "best" · gives a **full case for** and a **full case against**, with figures · **compares** her with other PMs (a table) and cites **historians' rankings** · reaches a **nuanced verdict** — "most transformative" v "best".

Answer 2 · Thatcherism: Economic and Educational Reforms and Their Impact

THE QUESTION · CSS 2024 · Q5 · Section B · 20 marks

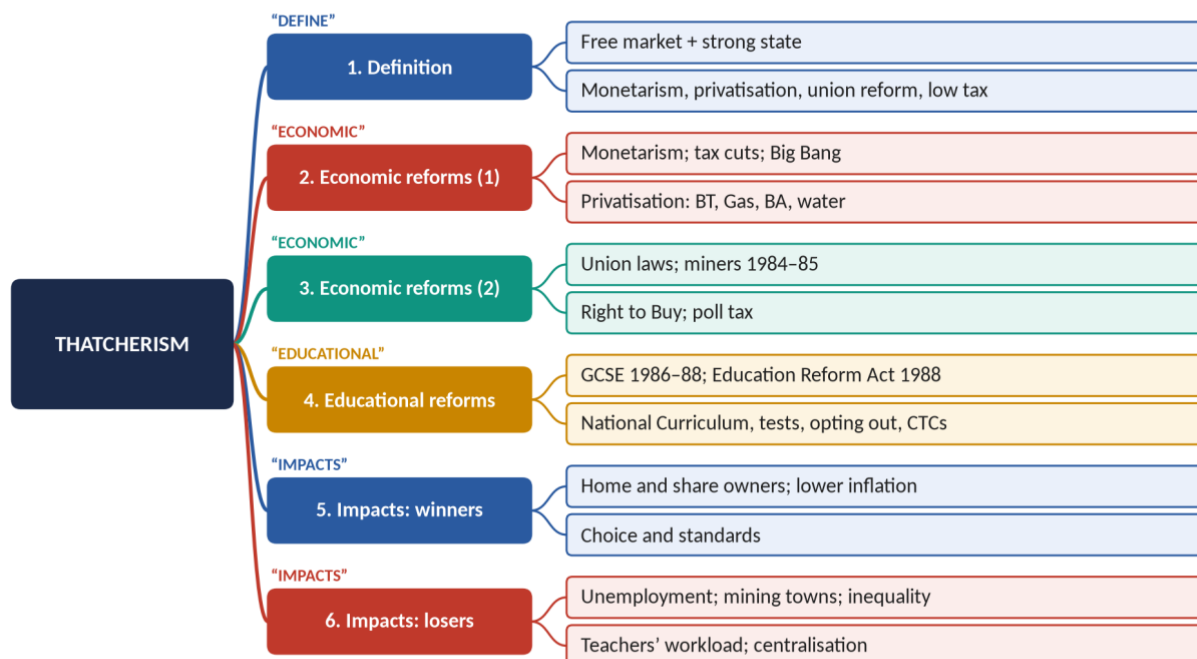
Define the term 'Thatcherism'. Discuss Margaret Thatcher's economic and educational reforms and their impacts on people's lives.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2024 · Q5 · SECTION B

Define the term 'Thatcherism'. Discuss Margaret Thatcher's economic and educational reforms and their impacts on people's lives.

KEY WORDS "Define Thatcherism" · "economic reforms" · "educational reforms" · "impacts on people's lives"

IT DEMANDS Three parts: a definition; the economic and the educational reforms (separately); and their impact on ordinary people — good and bad.



VERDICT

Thatcherism combined free-market economics with a strong state; its economic and educational reforms gave millions homes, shares and school choice, but left others unemployed, poorer and resentful.

Figure 2 · The answer map for CSS 2024 · Q5 · Section B; every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Three parts. (1) "Define the term 'Thatcherism'" — a clear definition and its main elements. (2) "Discuss Margaret Thatcher's economic and educational reforms" — **two** kinds of reform, each with its own section. (3) "... and their impacts on people's lives" — how ordinary people were affected, **good and bad**.

The model answer

Introduction

Thatcherism is the name given to the political ideas and policies of **Margaret Thatcher**, Conservative Prime Minister from **1979 to 1990** — a combination of **free-market economics** and a **strong state**. Through it she set out to reverse Britain's economic decline and end the post-war consensus. Her **economic** reforms — monetarism, privatisation, tax cuts, union laws and the sale of council houses — and her **educational** reforms — the GCSE and the Education Reform Act of 1988 — changed the lives of millions: many gained homes, shares, jobs in new industries and choice in schooling; many others lost their jobs, their communities and their security.

Part 1 · Defining Thatcherism

(1) Definition

***Thatcherism** is the belief that Britain's prosperity depends on **free markets**, **private enterprise** and **individual responsibility**, protected by a **strong state** that keeps order, curbs the power of the unions and defends national interests — "**the free economy and the strong state**" (Andrew Gamble).*

The term was coined by the writer **Stuart Hall** (1979).

THATCHERISM

The ideas and policies of Margaret Thatcher (PM 1979–1990)

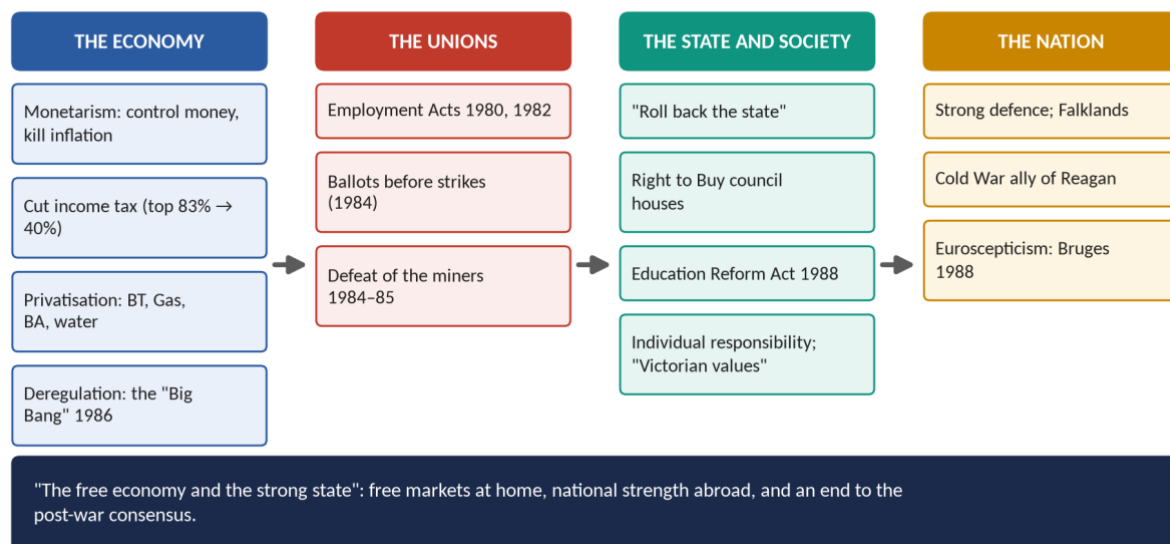


Figure 3 · The elements of Thatcherism.

(2) Its main elements

1. **Monetarism** (Milton Friedman): control the money supply to defeat **inflation**.
2. **Free markets and privatisation** (Friedrich Hayek).

3. **Low taxes** to reward enterprise.
4. **A smaller state** — "rolling back the frontiers of the state".
5. **Curbing trade-union power**.
6. **Self-reliance**, the family, "**Victorian values**".
7. **A property-owning democracy**.
8. **Law and order, strong defence, national sovereignty** (the Falklands; Euroscepticism).
9. **Conviction politics** instead of consensus.

Part 2 · The economic reforms

(3) Monetarism and tax reform

- **Howe's budget (1979)**: income tax cut (top rate 83 → 60 per cent; basic rate 33 → 30); **VAT** raised to **15 per cent** (a shift from taxing income to taxing spending); **exchange controls** abolished.
- High interest rates and spending cuts; the deep **recession** of **1980–81**.
- **Lawson** (1988): top rate **40 per cent**, basic rate **25 per cent**.

(4) Privatisation

British Telecom (1984), **British Gas** (1986, "Tell Sid"), **British Airways** (1987), **British Steel** (1988), the **water** companies (1989), **electricity** (1990) — about **£29 billion** raised.

(5) Deregulation

The **Big Bang** (1986) in the City; credit and mortgage controls removed.

(6) Trade-union reform

- **Employment Acts** (1980, 1982): limits on picketing and the closed shop.
- **Trade Union Act (1984)**: secret **ballots** before strikes.
- **The miners' strike (1984–85)** defeated; pit closures followed.

(7) Housing and local government

- **The Right to Buy (Housing Act 1980)**.
- The **GLC** abolished (1986); the **poll tax** (1989–90).

Part 3 · The educational reforms

(8) The GCSE

Announced in 1984, first taught in **1986**, first examined in **1988**: one exam for all 16-year-olds, replacing O-levels and CSEs, with more coursework.

(9) The Education Reform Act (1988)

Passed by **Kenneth Baker** — the biggest reform since 1944:

1. **The National Curriculum:** core subjects (English, maths, science) and foundation subjects for all state schools in England and Wales.
2. **National tests** ("SATs") at 7, 11 and 14.
3. **Local Management of Schools:** budgets given to heads and governors.
4. **Grant-maintained schools:** schools could **opt out** of local-authority control.
5. **City Technology Colleges**, with business sponsors.
6. **Open enrolment** and **parental choice** (league tables followed in 1992).
7. The **Inner London Education Authority** abolished; university **tenure** ended.

(10) The ideas behind them

Higher standards, **choice** and **competition** between schools, accountability to parents, and less power for local authorities and teachers' unions.

Part 4 · The impacts on people's lives

(11) Positive impacts

1. **Lower inflation:** savings and wages kept their value.
2. **Home ownership:** over **a million** council tenants bought their homes.
3. **Share ownership:** about **11 million** shareholders by 1990.
4. **Lower income tax:** more take-home pay, especially for higher earners.
5. **New jobs and wealth** in finance, services and the south-east; consumer spending rose.
6. **Better services** in some privatised industries (a phone line in days, not months).
7. **Education:** a common curriculum for every child; clear information for parents; more choice; more young people stayed on after 16.

(12) Negative impacts

1. **Unemployment:** over **3 million** (1982–87); mass redundancies in coal, steel, shipbuilding and manufacturing.
2. **Destroyed communities:** mining villages and industrial towns in the north, Scotland and Wales.
3. **Inequality:** the gap between rich and poor widened sharply; child poverty rose.
4. **Higher VAT** and the **poll tax** fell heavily on the poor.
5. **Housing shortage:** council houses sold but not replaced; later homelessness.
6. **Education:** heavy testing, teacher workload and strikes, more central control, bigger gaps between popular and struggling schools.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Thatcherism — free markets within a strong state — was carried out through far-reaching economic reforms (monetarism, tax cuts, privatisation, union laws, Right to Buy) and educational reforms (the GCSE and the Education Reform Act of 1988). Their impact on people's lives was deeply divided: millions gained homes, shares, lower taxes, lower inflation and more choice in schools, while millions of others lost their jobs and communities and saw inequality grow. That division is why Thatcher remains both the most admired and the most disliked Prime Minister of modern times.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

A **boxed definition** and its **elements** · **economic** and **educational** reforms in **separate** sections, with dates and figures · the **impacts** set out as **positive** and **negative**, as the question requires · a balanced conclusion.

Answer 3 · The Causes of the Falklands War and Its Effect on Relations with Latin America

THE QUESTION · CSS 2020 · Q8 · Section B · 20 marks

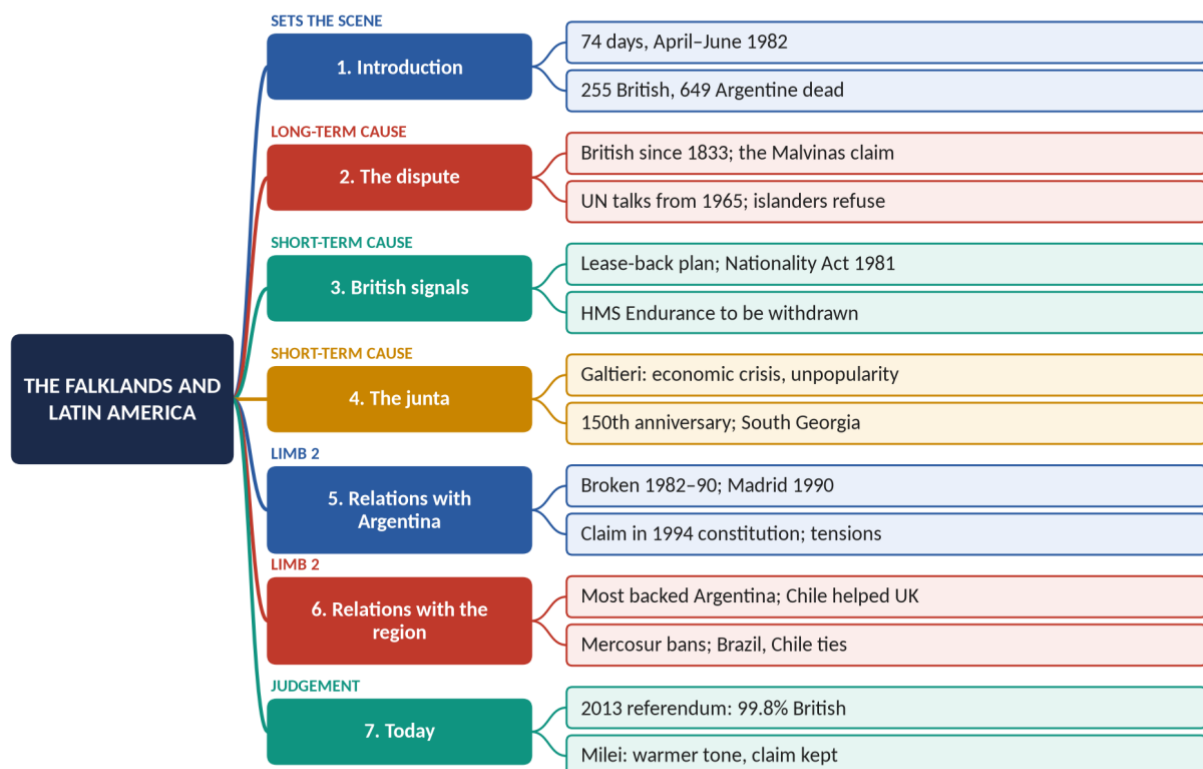
What were the causes of the Falkland War? In what way has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2020 · Q8 · SECTION B (ALSO 2022 · Q6)

What were the causes of the Falkland War? In what way has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?

KEY WORDS "causes" · "Falkland War" · "relationship with Latin American countries"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Causes — long-term (the sovereignty dispute) and short-term (1980–82). (2) Effects on relations with Latin America — Argentina and the region, from 1982 to today.



VERDICT

The war grew from an old sovereignty dispute that British neglect and an unpopular Argentine junta turned into invasion; it poisoned Anglo-Argentine relations for years and still shapes Britain's place in Latin America.

Figure 4 · The answer map for CSS 2020 · Q8 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "What were the causes of the Falkland War?" — the **long-term** cause (the sovereignty dispute) and the **short-term** causes (British signals and the Argentine junta's motives). (2) "In what way has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?" — **Argentina** in particular and the **region** in general, from **1982 to today**.

The model answer

Introduction

The **Falklands War (2 April – 14 June 1982)** was fought between **Britain** and **Argentina** over the **Falkland Islands** (Las Malvinas), a British territory in the South Atlantic with about **1,800** inhabitants of British descent. Argentina invaded; Britain sent a task force and retook the islands in 74 days, at the cost of **255** British and **649** Argentine lives. The war grew from an old **sovereignty dispute**, turned into war by **British signals of indifference** and the **political needs of Argentina's military junta**. It damaged Britain's relations with Argentina for years and left a lasting irritant in its relations with Latin America.

THE FALKLANDS WAR, APRIL–JUNE 1982

Numbered: 1 San Carlos landings (21 May) · 2 Goose Green (28 May) · 3 Stanley — surrender 14 June

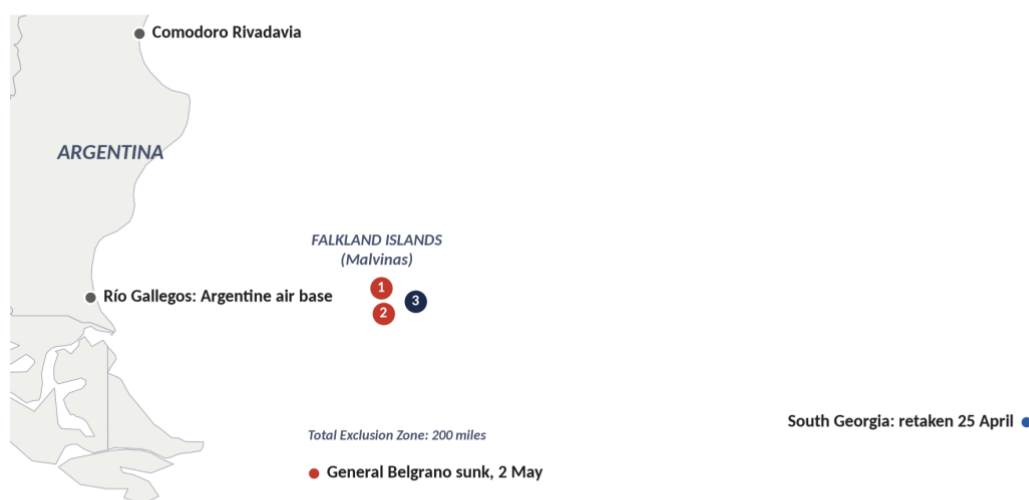


Figure 5 · The Falklands War.

Limb 1 · The causes

(1) The long-term cause: the sovereignty dispute

- **Rival claims:** British, French and Spanish settlements in the 18th century. **Argentina** claims it inherited Spain's rights on independence (**1816**) and had a settlement there in the 1820s.

- **1833**: Britain took control and expelled the Argentine garrison; British settlers followed. Argentina never accepted this.
- **Argentine nationalism**: every Argentine child learned that "**las Malvinas son argentinas**".
- **The UN: Resolution 2065 (1965)** called on the two countries to negotiate. Talks dragged on for 17 years.
- **The islanders' veto**: the islanders refused any transfer; Parliament supported them. **Nicholas Ridley's "lease-back" plan (1980)** was rejected.

(2) Short-term cause: British signals of weakness

1. **The 1981 Defence Review** (John Nott) announced the withdrawal of **HMS Endurance**, the only Royal Navy ship in the area.
2. **The British Nationality Act (1981)** denied the islanders full British citizenship.
3. Years of negotiation made the junta believe Britain did not really want the islands.
4. Britain ignored intelligence warnings in early 1982.

(3) Short-term cause: the Argentine junta

- **General Leopoldo Galtieri's** military government (from **December 1981**) faced an economic crisis (inflation over 100 per cent), mass protests and anger over the "**Dirty War**" — thousands of opponents "disappeared".
- A quick, popular victory would **unite the nation** behind the junta.
- **Timing**: the **150th anniversary** of British rule (**1983**) was approaching; the British navy was being cut; it was the southern winter.
- **Miscalculation**: the junta believed Britain would **not fight** at a distance of 8,000 miles, and that the **USA**, which valued Argentina as an anti-communist ally, would stay neutral.

(4) The trigger

On **19 March 1982** Argentine scrap-metal workers landed on **South Georgia** and raised the Argentine flag. When Britain protested, the junta brought its invasion forward to **2 April 1982**.

KEY IDEA · Weighing the causes

The **sovereignty dispute** made conflict possible; British **neglect** made it look safe; the **junta's** domestic crisis made it attractive. The decisive cause was the junta's **choice** to use force — based on the **miscalculation** that Britain would not respond.

Limb 2 · The effect on relations with Latin America

(5) Argentina — broken and restored relations

- **1982–1990**: diplomatic relations were **broken off**; trade and flights stopped.
- **The Madrid Declarations (1989–90)** restored relations under a "**sovereignty umbrella**": both sides agreed to cooperate while keeping their claims.

- **The 1990s:** better relations under President **Menem** (Prince Charles visited in 1999; the islanders' ban on Argentine visitors was lifted).
- **The 1994 Argentine constitution** declared the claim to the islands "**permanent and unrenounceable**".

(6) Argentina — renewed tension (2003–2015)

- Presidents **Néstor** and **Cristina Kirchner** revived the claim: protests at the UN, restrictions on flights and shipping, anger at British **oil exploration** (from 2010) and **fishing** licences.
- **The 2013 referendum: 99.8 per cent** of islanders (1,513 to 3) voted to remain British — Argentina rejected it.

(7) Argentina — cautious improvement (2015–2026)

- President **Macri** (2015–19) sought cooperation (flights, identification of Argentine war dead buried on the islands, 2017–18).
- President **Javier Milei** (from **December 2023**) praised Thatcher and sought closer ties with Britain, while insisting the claim would be pursued peacefully.

(8) The wider region

1. **Solidarity with Argentina:** in 1982 most Latin American governments and the **Organisation of American States** backed Argentina, seeing Britain as a colonial power; many still support Argentina's claim at the UN and in regional bodies.
2. **Mercosur** (2011) agreed to close its members' ports to ships flying the **Falklands flag**.
3. **Chile**, Argentina's rival, secretly helped Britain in 1982 (intelligence, radar) and remains a close partner.
4. **Brazil** and **Mexico** have built strong trade ties with Britain despite supporting Argentina.
5. **Suspicion of British military presence:** the garrison and the **Mount Pleasant** base are criticised as "militarising" the South Atlantic.
6. **Trade and cooperation:** after Brexit Britain sought new trade in Latin America (e.g. the UK–Mercosur dialogue; CPTPP membership alongside Chile, Peru and Mexico).

(9) Overall assessment

The war made the Falklands a **permanent irritant** in Britain's relations with Latin America: relations with Argentina were broken for eight years and have swung between hostility and cooperation ever since, and the region generally sides with Argentina's claim. But pragmatic trade and diplomacy have grown, and no country has seriously threatened force again.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The Falklands War was caused by a century and a half of unresolved sovereignty dispute, made dangerous by British signals of indifference and turned into war by a failing Argentine junta that gambled on Britain not fighting. Its effect on Britain's relations with Latin America has been lasting: a break with Argentina until 1990, recurring tension over the islands, and broad regional sympathy for Argentina's claim — softened, but never removed, by growing trade and pragmatic cooperation.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

The **causes** are layered — long-term, British signals, the junta, the trigger — and **weighed** in a key box · the **effects** cover **Argentina** in three phases (1982–90, 2003–15, 2015–26) and the **region**, with specific evidence (Madrid 1990, 1994 constitution, 2013 referendum, Mercosur, Chile) · a clear verdict.

Answer 4 · The Same Question, Set Again

THE QUESTION · CSS 2022 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

Explain the genesis of the Falkland War. How has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?

DECODING THE QUESTION

The full question: "**Explain the genesis of the Falkland War. How has it affected Britain's relationship with Latin American countries?**" This is **2020 Q8** (Answer 3) in different words: "**genesis**" means **origins** — how the war came about.

How to reuse Answer 3

1. Use "**genesis**" as your heading word: "The genesis of the war" — the long-term origins (1690–1965), the negotiations (1965–81), and the crisis (1981–82).
2. Tell it as a **sequence** rather than a list of causes: claims → 1833 → UN talks → lease-back → British signals → the junta's crisis → South Georgia → invasion. This suits "genesis" (a story of how something came to be).
3. **Limb 2** is identical: use sections (5)–(9) of Answer 3.
4. **Conclusion** as in Answer 3.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this works

The examiner set the same question two years apart; your prepared answer carries over, reshaped as a **narrative of origins** for "genesis".

Answer 5 · The Falkland Islands Conflict: What, Why and How It Ended

THE QUESTION · CSS 2021 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

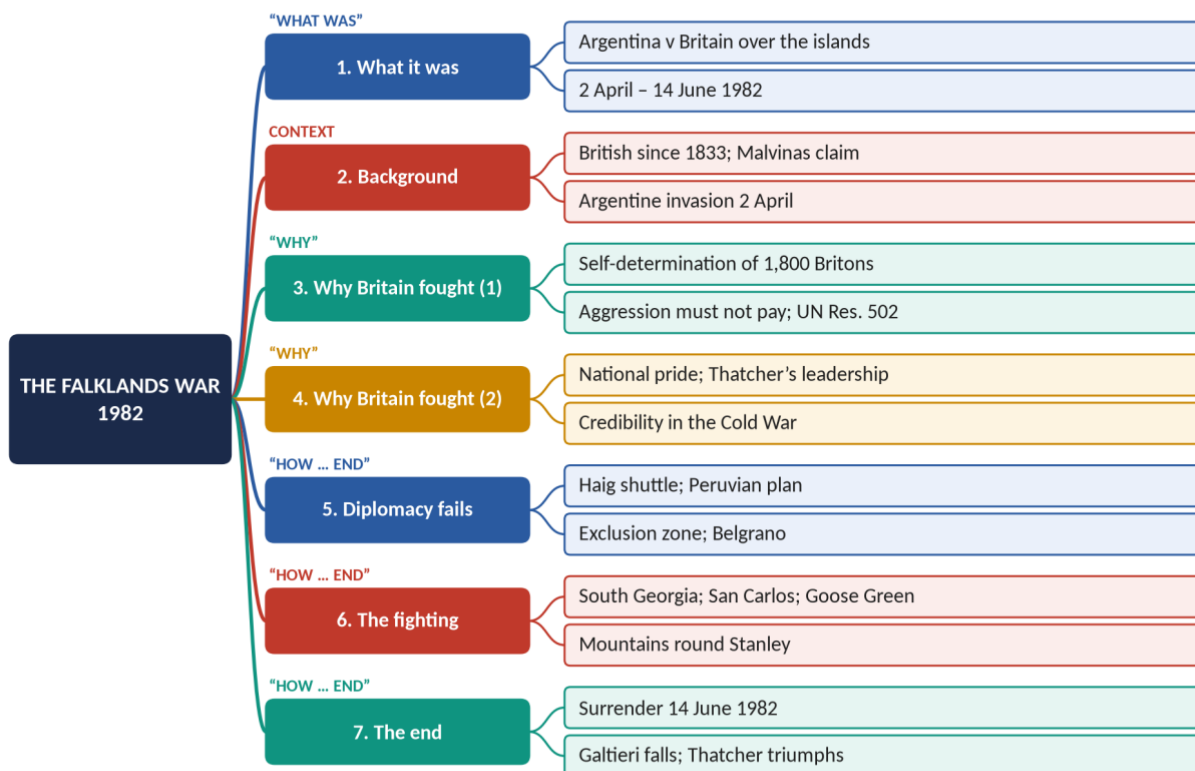
What was the Falkland Islands conflict? Why did the British invade the Falkland Islands and how did this war come to an end?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2021 · Q6 · SECTION B (SHORT NOTE: 2024)

What was the Falkland Islands conflict? Why did the British invade the Falkland Islands and how did this war come to an end?

KEY WORDS "What was" · "Why did the British invade" · "how did this war come to an end"

IT DEMANDS Three parts: what the conflict was; why Britain sent a task force to retake the islands (strictly, Argentina invaded and Britain retook them); how it ended — military and diplomatic.



VERDICT

The Falklands War was a 74-day conflict in which Britain retook islands Argentina had seized, to defend the islanders' wishes and resist aggression; it ended with Argentina's surrender at Stanley on 14 June 1982.

Figure 6 · The answer map for CSS 2021 · Q6 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Three parts. (1) "What was the Falkland Islands conflict?" — a clear description. (2) "Why did the British invade the Falkland Islands?" — note that **Argentina** invaded first; Britain sent forces to **retake** them — then give Britain's **reasons**. (3) "How did this war come to an end?" — the failed diplomacy, the military campaign and the surrender, plus the immediate aftermath.

The model answer

Introduction

The **Falkland Islands conflict** was a short war — **74 days**, from **2 April** to **14 June 1982** — between **Argentina** and **Britain** over the **Falkland Islands**, a British territory in the South Atlantic that Argentina calls **Las Malvinas**. Argentina seized the islands; Britain sent a naval **task force** 8,000 miles to recover them. Strictly, Britain did not "invade" but **retook** the islands, to defend the islanders' right to remain British and to show that aggression would not pay. The war ended with Argentina's **surrender at Stanley** on **14 June 1982**.

Part 1 · What was the conflict?

(1) The islands and the dispute

- About **500 km** off Argentina; about **1,800** inhabitants of British descent; capital **Stanley**.
- British since **1833**; Argentina has always claimed them.
- Negotiations since **1965** (UN Resolution 2065) failed because the islanders refused Argentine rule.

(2) The Argentine invasion

- The military junta of **General Galtieri**, facing economic crisis and unpopularity, decided on a quick, popular victory.
- **19 March 1982**: Argentine workers raised their flag on **South Georgia**.
- **2 April 1982**: Argentine forces landed near Stanley (**Operation Rosario**); the 68 Royal Marines surrendered. **South Georgia** fell on **3 April**.

(3) The two sides

- **Argentina**: about 10,000 troops on the islands; air force with French **Exocet** missiles and US-built Skyhawks.
- **Britain**: a task force of about 100 ships (the carriers **Hermes** and **Invincible**), some 28,000 men; Harrier jets.

Part 2 · Why Britain sent forces to retake the islands

(4) Self-determination

The islanders were British by birth and wished to remain so. Thatcher: "The people of the Falkland Islands ... are British ... and their allegiance is to the Crown."

(5) International law — aggression must not pay

The invasion was an armed seizure of territory. The **UN Security Council** passed **Resolution 502 (3 April)** demanding Argentine withdrawal. If Britain accepted the invasion, other aggressors would be encouraged.

(6) National pride and credibility

Surrender would have been a humiliation for a country that had lost an empire; it would have damaged Britain's standing as a **NATO** power in the Cold War.

(7) Political pressure and leadership

- An emergency **Commons** debate (**Saturday 3 April**) demanded action; **Lord Carrington**, the Foreign Secretary, resigned (5 April).
- **Thatcher's** conviction and her government's survival were at stake.

(8) It was militarily possible

The navy's chiefs (Admiral Leach) assured her that a task force could retake the islands.

Part 3 · How the war came to an end

(9) Diplomacy fails (April–May)

- **Alexander Haig**, the US Secretary of State, shuttled between London and Buenos Aires; the junta refused to withdraw. On **30 April** the **USA** came down on Britain's side, providing intelligence, fuel and missiles.
- **The EEC** imposed sanctions on Argentina; the **Commonwealth** mostly supported Britain.
- **A Peruvian peace plan** collapsed after the sinking of the *Belgrano* (**2 May**).
- **The UN** Secretary-General's efforts failed (May).

(10) The war at sea and in the air

- A 200-mile **Exclusion Zone** (April).
- **South Georgia** retaken (**25 April**).
- **2 May**: the submarine *Conqueror* sank the cruiser **General Belgrano** — **323** dead. The Argentine navy stayed in port for the rest of the war.
- **4 May**: *HMS Sheffield* hit by an **Exocet**; later *Ardent*, *Antelope*, *Coventry* and the *Atlantic Conveyor* were sunk by air attack.

(11) The land campaign

- **21 May:** landings at **San Carlos** on East Falkland.
- **28 May:** **2 Para** captured **Goose Green**.
- Marines and paratroopers "**yomped**" across East Falkland to the mountains around Stanley.
- **8 June:** the *Sir Galahad* was bombed at Bluff Cove — about 50 dead.
- **11–14 June:** night battles for **Mount Longdon**, **Mount Tumbledown** and **Wireless Ridge**.

(12) The surrender

On **14 June 1982** General **Mario Menéndez surrendered** his forces at **Stanley**; about **11,000** Argentine prisoners were returned home.

Casualties	Numbers
British servicemen	255
Argentine servicemen	649
Falkland islanders	3

(13) The immediate aftermath

- **Argentina:** Galtieri was forced out (**17 June**); the junta collapsed; **democracy** returned (**Alfonsín, 1983**).
- **Britain:** Thatcher's popularity soared — the "**Falklands factor**" in her **1983** landslide; the **Franks Report** (1983) on the causes; full British **citizenship** for the islanders (1983); a permanent garrison (**Mount Pleasant, 1985**).
- **The dispute** was not settled: Argentina maintains its claim.

VERDICT · Conclusion

The Falklands conflict was a 74-day war in 1982 in which Britain recovered islands that Argentina's military junta had seized. Britain fought to defend the islanders' wish to remain British, to uphold international law against aggression, and to protect its national pride and credibility. After diplomacy failed, the war was decided by the sinking of the *Belgrano*, the landings at San Carlos and the battles around Stanley, and it ended with Argentina's surrender on 14 June 1982 — bringing down the junta and restoring democracy in Argentina, and strengthening Thatcher at home.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Three parts, three sections · it **corrects** the question's wording politely ("retook", not "invaded") — showing precise knowledge · **reasons** for British action are numbered · the **end** covers diplomacy, sea, land and surrender with **dates** and **casualties** · the aftermath completes "how it ended".

Answer 6 · Why Major Won in 1992 but Lost in 1997

THE QUESTION · CSS 2019 · Q8 · Section B · 20 marks

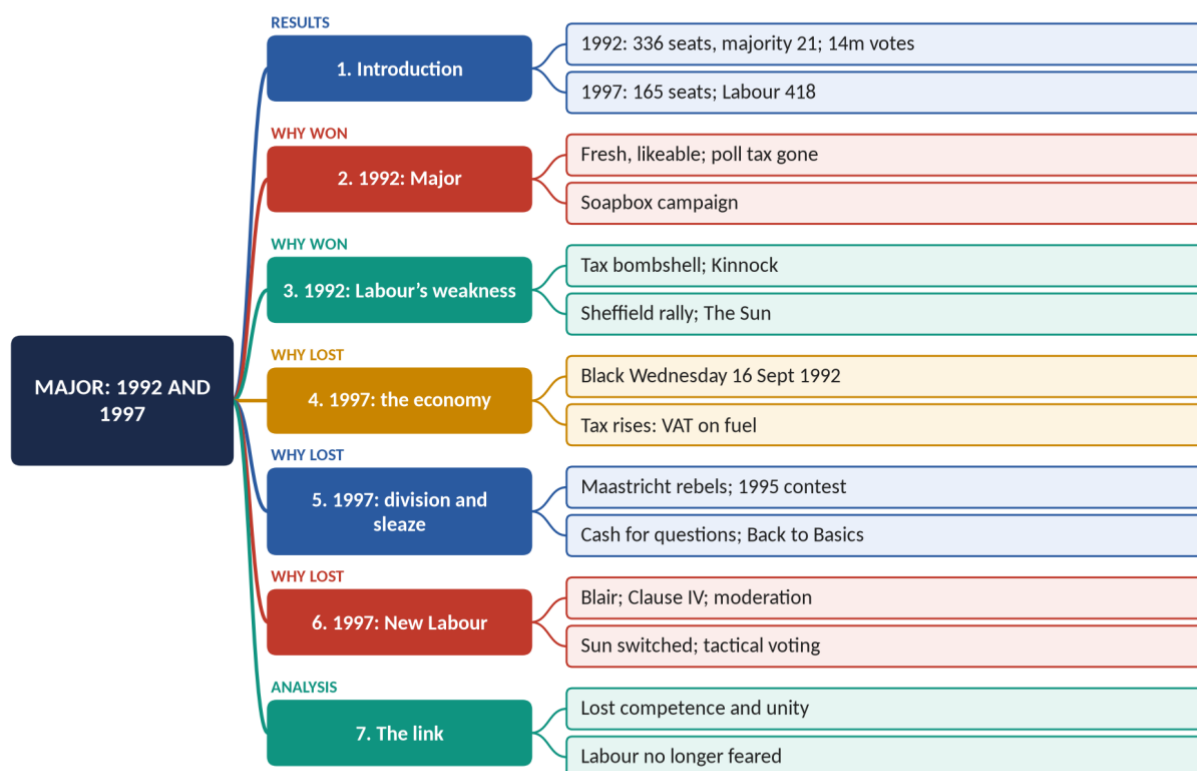
Explain why John Major and the Conservatives won the general election of 1992 but lost the election of 1997.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2019 · Q8 · SECTION B

Explain why John Major and the Conservatives won the general election of 1992 but lost the election of 1997.

KEY WORDS “won ... 1992” · “lost ... 1997” · “Explain why”

IT DEMANDS Two sets of reasons: why they won in 1992, and why they lost in 1997 — then link them (what changed in between).



VERDICT

The Conservatives won in 1992 because voters trusted Major more than Kinnock with the economy; they lost in 1997 because Black Wednesday, division over Europe and sleaze destroyed that trust while Blair made Labour safe.

Figure 7 · The answer map for CSS 2019 · Q8 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"Explain why" two opposite results: the Conservative **victory** of **April 1992** and their **defeat** of **May 1997**. Give **reasons** for each, grouped, and then **link** them — what changed between 1992 and 1997?

The model answer

Introduction

John Major became Prime Minister in **November 1990** after Margaret Thatcher's fall. Against most predictions, he won the general election of **9 April 1992**, with a majority of **21** and about **14 million** votes — the largest number ever won by a British party. Five years later, on **1 May 1997**, the Conservatives suffered their worst defeat since **1906**, reduced to **165** seats against Labour's **418**. The Conservatives won in 1992 because voters trusted them — and Major — more than Labour on the economy; they lost in 1997 because **Black Wednesday**, **division over Europe** and **sleaze** destroyed that trust, while **Tony Blair's** "New Labour" made Labour safe to vote for.

JOHN MAJOR: VICTORY IN 1992, DEFEAT IN 1997

From a 21-seat majority to Labour's 179-seat landslide

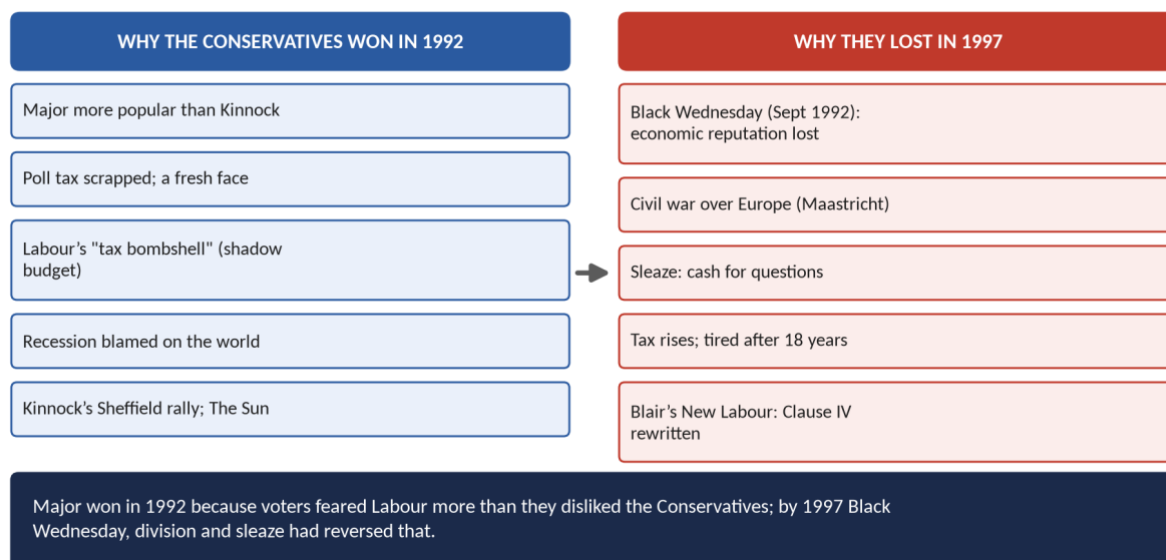


Figure 8 · 1992 and 1997.

Why the Conservatives won in 1992

(1) A new leader

- **Major** was modest, likeable and seen as a fresh start after Thatcher; his "**soapbox**" campaign (speaking from a box in town centres) gave him a common touch.
- He had removed the hated **poll tax** (replaced by the Council Tax) and led Britain through the successful **Gulf War** (1991).

(2) Fear of Labour's taxes

- Labour's Shadow Chancellor **John Smith** published a "**shadow budget**" with higher taxes on the better-off.

- The Conservatives' campaign — "**Labour's Tax Bombshell**" and "**Double Whammy**" (higher taxes and higher prices) — persuaded many middle-income voters that they would pay more.

(3) Doubts about Neil Kinnock

- Voters did not see **Kinnock** as a Prime Minister; his over-confident **Sheffield rally** (1 April) looked triumphalist.
- The popular press, led by **The Sun**, attacked him ("If Kinnock wins today will the last person to leave Britain please turn out the lights"); afterwards it boasted "**It's The Sun Wot Won It**".

(4) Economic trust

Although Britain was in **recession**, voters blamed world conditions and still trusted the Conservatives more than Labour to manage the economy — memories of the **1970s** and of Labour's divisions in the 1980s remained.

(5) The "shy Tories"

Opinion polls showed a Labour lead; many Conservative voters did not admit their intentions — the pollsters' failure hid the Conservatives' real support.

Why the Conservatives lost in 1997

(6) Black Wednesday — the loss of economic credibility

- On **16 September 1992**, only five months after the election, speculators forced the pound out of the **ERM**; the government raised interest rates to **15 per cent** in a day and spent billions of reserves, but failed.
- The Conservatives lost their reputation for **economic competence** at once and never regained it, even though the economy then grew steadily with falling unemployment and inflation.

(7) Broken promises on tax

To close the budget deficit, the government raised taxes — including **VAT on domestic fuel and power** (1994) — despite its 1992 campaign against Labour's tax rises.

(8) Division over Europe

- **The Maastricht Treaty**: Conservative rebels fought the bill in 1992–93; Major needed a **vote of confidence** to pass it (**July 1993**).
- Major was heard calling three Eurosceptic cabinet ministers "**bastards**" (1993); the whip was withdrawn from eight rebel MPs (1994).
- In **1995** he resigned the party leadership, telling his critics to "**put up or shut up**"; he beat **John Redwood**, but the party remained divided.
- **The Referendum Party** (Sir James Goldsmith) and **UKIP** took Eurosceptic votes in 1997.

(9) Sleaze

- **"Cash for questions" (1994)**: MPs (including **Neil Hamilton**) had taken money to ask parliamentary questions.
- **Jonathan Aitken** sued a newspaper and was later jailed for perjury.
- Sexual scandals made Major's **"Back to Basics"** campaign (1993) look hypocritical.
- The **Nolan Committee** on standards in public life (1994) was set up.

(10) Other problems

- **The BSE ("mad cow") crisis** (1996) and the European ban on British beef.
- Unpopular **rail privatisation**.
- A weak-looking leader; a narrow and shrinking majority.
- **Time for a change**: 18 years of Conservative government.

(11) New Labour

- **Tony Blair** became Labour leader in **1994** after John Smith's death.
- He rewrote **Clause IV (1995)**, dropping the commitment to nationalisation, and renamed the party **"New Labour"**.
- He promised not to raise income tax, to keep Conservative spending limits for two years, and to be tough on crime.
- He won over business and ***The Sun*** (which backed Labour in 1997).
- **Tactical voting** between Labour and Liberal Democrat supporters removed many Conservative MPs.

Linking the two elections

Factor	1992	1997
Economic trust	Conservatives trusted	Lost on Black Wednesday
Taxes	"Labour's tax bombshell"	Conservative tax rises; Labour promised no rise
Party unity	Fairly united behind Major	Civil war over Europe
Reputation	Fresh leader	Sleaze; tired
The opposition	Kinnock distrusted	Blair trusted; New Labour moderate
The press	<i>The Sun</i> for Major	<i>The Sun</i> for Blair

VERDICT · Conclusion

The Conservatives won in 1992 because Major was more trusted than Kinnock, because voters feared Labour's taxes, and because they still trusted the Conservatives with the economy. By 1997 every one of these advantages had been reversed: Black Wednesday destroyed their economic reputation, their own tax rises undermined their attacks on Labour, Europe split the party, sleaze disgraced it, and Tony Blair made Labour look moderate and safe. The result was the largest Conservative defeat for ninety years.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

Reasons for 1992 and **reasons for 1997** in separate, numbered groups · specific evidence (Tax Bombshell, Black Wednesday, "put up or shut up", cash for questions, Clause IV) · a **linking table** explains what changed — the "why" behind both results.

Answer 7 · Britain's Contribution to the Common Market and the European Union

THE QUESTION · CSS 2021 · Q7 · Section B · 20 marks

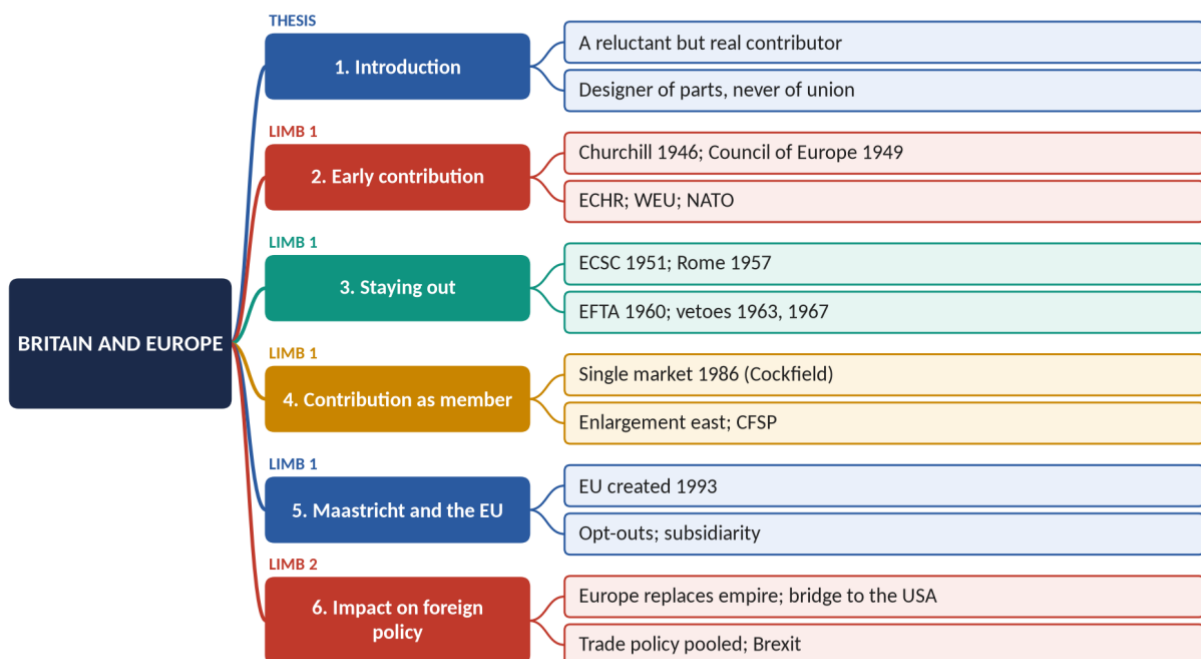
What was the contribution of Great Britain to the formation of the European Common Market and the European Union? Also highlight its impact on the foreign policy of Britain.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2021 · Q7 · SECTION B (SHORT NOTE: 2018)

What was the contribution of Great Britain to the formation of the European Common Market and the European Union? Also highlight its impact on the foreign policy of Britain.

KEY WORDS "contribution" · "formation" · "Common Market" · "European Union" · "impact on foreign policy"

IT DEMANDS Two limbs. (1) Britain's contribution to building European institutions — honest about its reluctance. (2) How membership affected British foreign policy.



VERDICT

Britain helped shape post-war Europe — the Council of Europe, the single market, enlargement — but always resisted political union; membership reshaped its foreign policy until Brexit ended it.

Figure 9 · The answer map for CSS 2021 · Q7 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two limbs. (1) "What was the contribution of Great Britain to the formation of the European Common Market and the European Union?" — what Britain **did** to create or shape these institutions (be honest: it stayed out of the Common Market's founding). (2) "Also highlight its impact on the foreign policy of Britain" — how membership (1973–2020) changed British foreign policy.

The model answer

Introduction

Britain's contribution to European integration is a paradox. It **inspired** the post-war idea of a united Europe (Churchill, 1946) and **helped build** the Council of Europe and the European Convention on Human Rights, but it **refused to join** the founding of the European Common Market (EEC, 1957). Once a member (from **1973**), it made major contributions — above all the **single market** (1986) and the **enlargement** of the Union to the east — and it helped shape the **Maastricht Treaty** (1992) that created the **European Union**, while securing **opt-outs** from its most ambitious parts. Membership transformed British foreign policy: Europe replaced the empire as Britain's main framework, and Britain became a "bridge" between the USA and Europe — until **Brexit** (2020).

BRITAIN AND EUROPE, 1946–2026

From reluctant founder to departing member

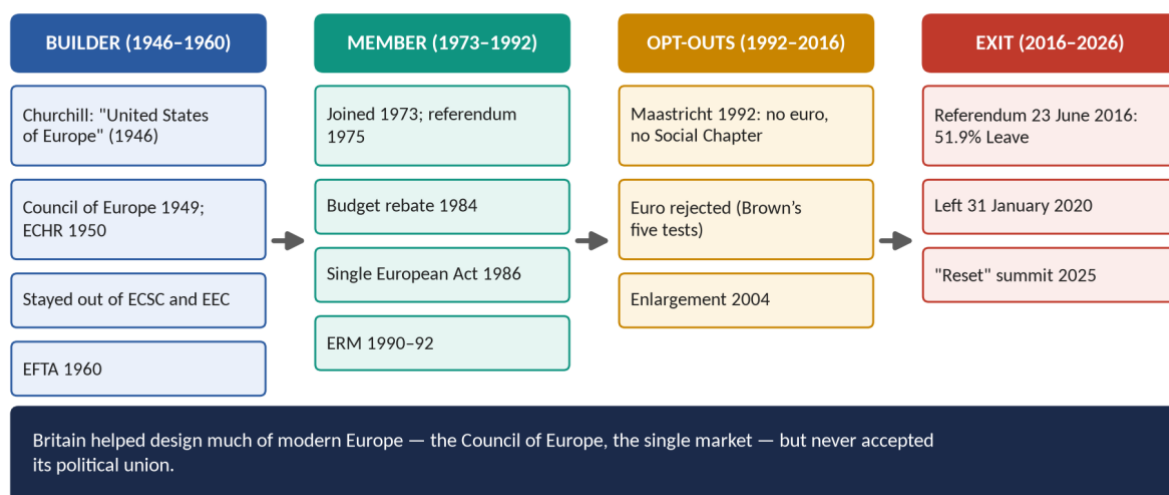


Figure 10 · Britain and Europe, 1946–2026.

Limb 1 · Britain's contribution

(1) Inspiration and early building (1946–1955)

- **Churchill's Zurich speech (1946)** called for "a kind of United States of Europe" built on Franco-German reconciliation — one of the founding visions of European unity.

- **Ernest Bevin** led Western Europe's response to the **Marshall Plan** (the **OEEC**, 1948) and built the **Brussels Treaty** (1948) and **NATO** (1949).
- **The Council of Europe (1949)**: Britain was a founding member (Treaty of London).
- **The European Convention on Human Rights (1950)**: drafted largely by British lawyers (David Maxwell Fyfe).
- **The Western European Union (1954)**: Eden's plan allowed West German rearmament within Western Europe.

(2) Standing aside from the Common Market (1950–1972)

- Britain refused to join the **European Coal and Steel Community (1951)** and the **Messina** talks that led to the **Treaty of Rome (1957)**, which created the **EEC** — because of the **Commonwealth**, the **USA**, **national sovereignty**, and confidence in its own strength.
- It formed **EFTA (1960)** as a looser free-trade alternative.
- Its later applications (**1961**, **1967**) were vetoed by **de Gaulle**.
- **So Britain made no direct contribution to the founding of the Common Market** — a decision many historians regard as a mistake ("missing the bus").

(3) Contributions as a member (1973–1992)

- **Entry (1 January 1973)** with Ireland and Denmark enlarged the Community; the **1975 referendum** (67 per cent) confirmed it.
- **Regional policy**: Britain pressed for the **European Regional Development Fund** (1975).
- **Budget reform**: Thatcher's **rebate (Fontainebleau, 1984)** forced reform of the Community's finances.
- **The single market** — Britain's greatest contribution: the **Single European Act (1986)** and the programme to remove barriers to trade in goods, services, capital and people by **1992**, designed by the British commissioner **Lord Cockfield**.
- **Enlargement**: Britain championed the entry of Greece (1981), Spain and Portugal (1986) and, after the Cold War, the new democracies of Central and Eastern Europe (achieved **2004**).
- **Foreign-policy cooperation**: Britain was a leading voice in **European Political Cooperation** (from 1970).

(4) Maastricht and the creation of the European Union (1991–1993)

- **Major** negotiated the **Maastricht Treaty (December 1991)**, which created the **European Union (1 November 1993)** with three "pillars": the European Community; a **Common Foreign and Security Policy**; cooperation in **justice and home affairs**.
- **Britain's contributions**: the **pillar structure**, keeping foreign policy and justice **intergovernmental**; the principle of **subsidiarity**; stronger powers for the Court of Auditors.
- **Britain's opt-outs**: from the **single currency** and the **Social Chapter**.

(5) Later contributions (1997–2016)

- Blair signed the **Social Chapter** (1997).
- **European defence**: the **St Malo Declaration** (1998) with France launched the EU's defence policy.
- **Enlargement** (2004, 2007) and the **Lisbon Treaty** (2007).
- Leadership on **climate change**, **sanctions** on Iran and Russia, **development aid**.

Limb 2 · The impact on British foreign policy

(6) From empire to Europe

Membership replaced the **Commonwealth** as Britain's main economic and diplomatic framework; trade with Europe rose to about half of Britain's total. It answered Acheson's jibe that Britain had "lost an empire and not yet found a role".

(7) A bridge between America and Europe

Britain used its **special relationship** with the USA to gain influence in Europe, and its EU membership to gain influence in Washington. But the bridge could be strained — above all over **Iraq** (2003), when Blair sided with the USA against France and Germany.

(8) Pooled powers

Trade policy was handed to the EU, which negotiated trade deals for all members; foreign policy increasingly worked through **common positions** and **sanctions**.

(9) The "awkward partner"

Britain resisted federalism, secured **opt-outs** (the euro, the Social Chapter, Schengen), fought over the budget and often found itself isolated — Stephen George's "**awkward partner**".

(10) After Brexit (2020–2026)

- "**Global Britain**": independent trade deals (Australia, New Zealand, Japan), joining the **CPTPP** (2023), the **AUKUS** pact (2021), a "tilt" to the Indo-Pacific.
- Close cooperation with Europe over **Ukraine** (from 2022), and a "**reset**" under **Starmer** — the **May 2025** summit agreed a security and defence partnership.

VERDICT · Conclusion

Britain's contribution to European integration was real but selective: it inspired the post-war vision, built the Council of Europe and the Human Rights Convention, stayed out of the Common Market's founding, and then, as a member, gave the Community its single market, drove its enlargement and shaped the Maastricht Treaty that created the European Union — while opting out of its deepest integration. Membership turned British foreign policy from empire to Europe and made Britain a bridge across the Atlantic, but its reluctance to accept political union finally led it out of the Union in 2020.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It is **honest** about the paradox — Britain did **not** help found the EEC — which examiners reward · the **contributions** are specific (ECHR, single market/Cockfield, enlargement, Maastricht's pillars and subsidiarity, St Malo) · **Limb 2** covers the impact from 1973 to **Brexit** and after · a balanced verdict.

Answer 8 · European Integration and British Politics and Identity since 1973

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q6 · Section B · 20 marks

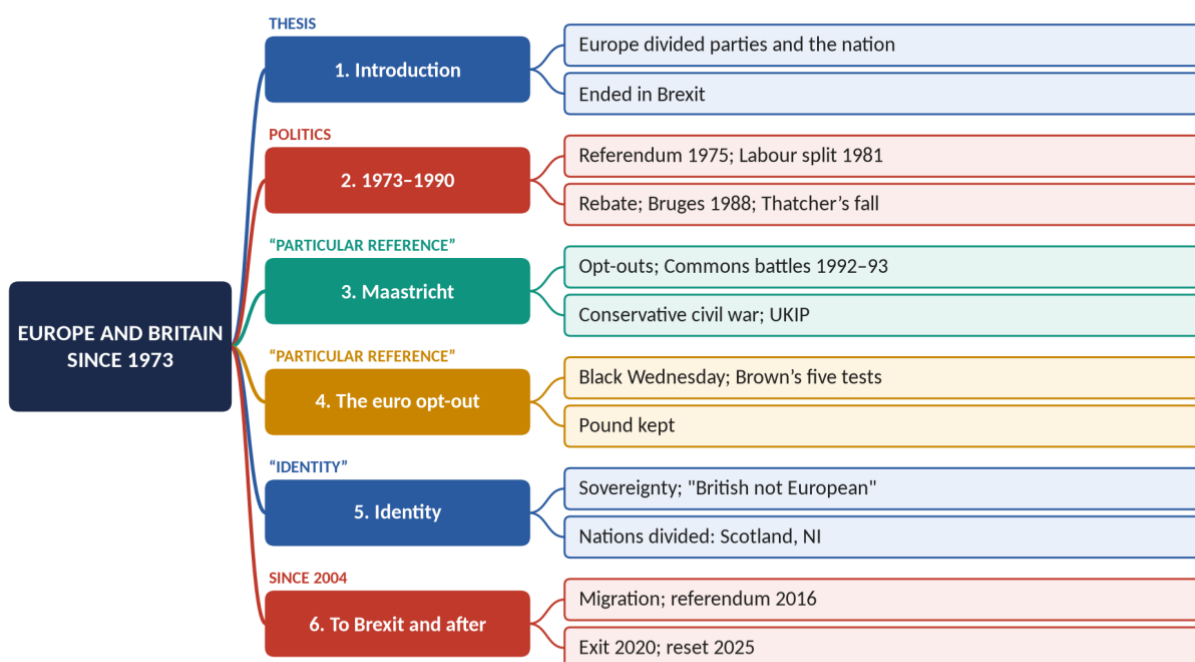
Discuss the impact of European integration on British politics and identity since 1973, with particular reference to the debates surrounding the Maastricht Treaty and the UK's opt-out from the euro.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2026 · Q6 · SECTION B

Discuss the impact of European integration on British politics and identity since 1973, with particular reference to the debates surrounding the Maastricht Treaty and the UK's opt-out from the euro.

KEY WORDS "impact" · "British politics" · "identity" · "since 1973" · "Maastricht" · "opt-out from the euro"

IT DEMANDS Impact on two things — politics and identity — across the whole period, with the Maastricht and euro debates given most space.



VERDICT

European integration split both main parties, brought down Thatcher and weakened Major, sharpened questions of sovereignty and identity — and through Maastricht and the euro debate set the road to Brexit.

Figure 11 · The answer map for CSS 2026 · Q6 · Section B: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"Discuss the impact of European integration on British politics and identity since 1973" — two things affected: **politics** (parties, leaders, Parliament, elections, referendums) and **identity** (how the British see themselves — British, English, Scottish, European; sovereignty). "With particular reference to the debates surrounding the Maastricht Treaty and the UK's opt-out from the euro" — these two debates must have the **most space**. Cover the whole period to the present.

The model answer

Introduction

Since Britain joined the European Community on **1 January 1973**, **European integration** has been the most divisive question in British politics. It split both major parties, brought down or broke several Prime Ministers, created new parties, introduced national referendums, and raised deep questions about **sovereignty** and **identity** — whether the British saw themselves as Europeans at all. The debates over the **Maastricht Treaty** (1992) and the **single currency** were the turning point: they turned Conservative doubts into open civil war, made Euroscepticism a mass movement, and set Britain on the road to **Brexit** (2016–2020).

Politics, 1973–1990

(1) Labour's divisions

- Labour was split over membership: Wilson held the **1975 referendum** (67 per cent Yes) with ministers campaigning on both sides.
- In **1983** Labour promised to leave the EEC; its pro-European right had already broken away to form the **SDP (1981)**.

(2) Thatcher and Europe

- The **rebate** (1984) and the **Single European Act** (1986) — she supported the single market, but not a political union.
- **The Bruges speech (1988)** rejected "a European super-state" and inspired Conservative Eurosceptics.
- Disagreement over the **ERM** and European union led to the resignations of **Lawson** (1989) and **Howe** (1990), and to her **fall (November 1990)**.

(3) Sovereignty in law

The **Factortame** case (**1990**) showed that **EU law** could override an **Act of Parliament** — a direct challenge to the traditional idea of parliamentary sovereignty.

The Maastricht debates (1991–1993)

(4) What Maastricht did

The **Maastricht Treaty** (agreed December **1991**, signed **February 1992**) created the **European Union**: a timetable for **economic and monetary union** (the single currency), a **Common Foreign and Security Policy**, cooperation in justice and home affairs, and **European citizenship**.

(5) Major's opt-outs

John Major secured **opt-outs** from the **single currency** and the **Social Chapter**, and the principle of **subsidiarity** — his team called it "**game, set and match**".

(6) The ratification crisis

- **Denmark's** "No" vote (June 1992) and **Black Wednesday** (September 1992) strengthened opponents.
- A group of Conservative "**Maastricht rebels**" (about 20–40 MPs) voted repeatedly against the bill; Labour opposed the opt-out from the Social Chapter.
- Major lost a key vote and had to call a **vote of confidence (July 1993)** to pass the treaty.
- The fight damaged his authority permanently: the "**bastards**" remark (1993), the whip withdrawn from eight rebels (1994), and the "**put up or shut up**" leadership election (1995).

(7) New Eurosceptic politics

- **UKIP** was founded (**1993**) to take Britain out of the EU.
- **The Referendum Party** (Goldsmith, 1994–97) won about 800,000 votes in 1997.
- The Conservatives' divisions helped **Labour's landslide (1997)**.

The euro opt-out

(8) Black Wednesday and the euro

- The pound's forced exit from the **ERM (16 September 1992)** made monetary union politically toxic: many voters linked European monetary integration with economic humiliation.

(9) Blair and Brown

- **Blair** favoured joining the euro in principle, but **Gordon Brown** set **five economic tests (October 1997)** — on convergence, flexibility, investment, the City and jobs.
- The euro was launched in **1999** (notes and coins in **2002**) without Britain; the Treasury's assessment (**2003**) found the tests not met; the idea was dropped.

(10) Why the opt-out mattered

- It kept the **pound** — a powerful symbol of **national identity** and sovereignty (the Bank of England, the Queen's head on the notes).
- It kept Britain **outside the core** of the EU, especially after the **euro crisis** (2010–12) made the eurozone integrate further — making Britain feel a second-class member and strengthening the case that it was different.

From Maastricht to Brexit (2004–2020)

(11) The road to the referendum

- **Enlargement (2004)** and free movement brought large-scale immigration from Eastern Europe — making immigration central to the European debate.
- **The Lisbon Treaty** (2007) was ratified without a referendum, angering Eurosceptics.
- **UKIP** won the European elections (**2014**); **Cameron** promised a referendum (**Bloomberg speech, 2013**).
- **The referendum (23 June 2016): 51.9 per cent** Leave. Cameron resigned; **Theresa May** fell over her Brexit deal (2019); **Boris Johnson** took Britain out on **31 January 2020**.

The impact on identity

(12) "British, not European"

- Surveys consistently found that the British, especially the **English**, had one of the **weakest European identities** in the EU; most described themselves as "British only".
- Island geography, a history of empire and victory in two world wars, a common-law tradition and the **special relationship** with the USA all set Britain apart.

(13) Sovereignty

The argument that decisions should be made by the British **Parliament**, not in **Brussels**, ran from Bruges (1988) through Maastricht to "**Take Back Control**" (2016).

(14) A divided nation

- **The nations: Scotland** (62 per cent Remain) and **Northern Ireland** (56 per cent Remain) felt more European than **England**; Brexit strengthened Scottish nationalism and complicated the Irish border (the Protocol, the **Windsor Framework, 2023**).
- **Generations, education and places:** the young, graduates and big cities were pro-European; older voters and post-industrial towns voted Leave — the "**left behind**".

Summary of the impact

Area	Impact
Parties	Labour split (1975–83, SDP 1981); Conservative civil war (1990s, 2016–19); UKIP, Referendum Party, Brexit Party / Reform UK
Leaders	Thatcher's fall (1990); Major's authority broken; Cameron (2016) and May (2019) brought down
Constitution	Referendums (1975, 2016); Factortame and EU law; devolution tensions
Identity	"British not European"; sovereignty; the nations divided; age and place divides

VERDICT · Conclusion

European integration has shaped British politics and identity more than any other issue since 1973. It split both major parties and destroyed or weakened four Prime Ministers; through Maastricht it turned Conservative unease into civil war and gave birth to UKIP; through the euro opt-out it kept the pound as a symbol of national sovereignty and left Britain outside Europe's core. Because most British people never came to see themselves as Europeans, these debates led, step by step, to the vote to leave in 2016 — and even after Brexit the question of Britain's relationship with Europe remains unsettled.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES · Why this answer scores

It covers **both politics and identity** across the **whole period** · **Maastricht** and the **euro** have the **most space**, as "particular reference" demands, with dates and details · the link from Maastricht to **Brexit** is explained · a **summary table** · a clear verdict.

Short Notes

Britain's Role in the European Union

THE QUESTION · CSS 2018 · Q8(b) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Britain's role in the EU

- **Before membership:** Churchill's call for a "United States of Europe" (1946); a founder of the **Council of Europe** (1949) and the **European Convention on Human Rights** (1950); stayed out of the **EEC** (1957); **EFTA** (1960); vetoed by de Gaulle (1963, 1967).
- **Member** from **1 January 1973**; the **1975** referendum (67 per cent Yes).
- **Contributions:** the **single market** (**Single European Act 1986**, designed by Lord **Cockfield**); **enlargement** to Southern and Eastern Europe (2004); the budget **rebate** (1984); **subsidiarity** and the pillar structure at **Maastricht** (1992); European defence (**St Malo**, 1998); climate change, sanctions, aid.
- **An "awkward partner":** opt-outs from the **euro**, the **Social Chapter** (until 1997) and **Schengen**; hostility to federalism (**Bruges**, 1988); the ERM exit (1992).
- **A bridge** between the EU and the **USA**; one of the "big three" with France and Germany; a permanent member of the UN Security Council within the EU.
- **Exit:** the **2016 referendum** (51.9 per cent Leave); Britain left on **31 January 2020**; the Trade and Cooperation Agreement (2020); the Windsor Framework (2023); a "**reset**" in **2025**.

In one line: a major but reluctant member that shaped the single market and enlargement, resisted political union, and finally left.

The Falklands War (1982)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2024 · Q7(a) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Falkland War

- **What:** a 74-day war (**2 April – 14 June 1982**) between **Argentina** and **Britain** over the **Falkland Islands** (Las Malvinas), a British territory since **1833** with about **1,800** British inhabitants.
- **Causes:** the old sovereignty dispute; British signals of weakness (the withdrawal of **HMS Endurance**, the 1981 Nationality Act); the unpopular junta of **General Galtieri** seeking a patriotic victory; the belief that Britain would not fight.
- **Invasion:** Argentina seized the islands on **2 April**; **UN Resolution 502** demanded withdrawal; **Lord Carrington** resigned; a **task force** sailed.
- **War:** US mediation (Haig) failed; **South Georgia** retaken (25 April); the **General Belgrano** sunk (**2 May**, 323 dead); **HMS Sheffield** sunk (4 May); landings at **San Carlos** (21 May); **Goose Green** (28 May); the mountains around Stanley.

- **End:** Argentine **surrender at Stanley (14 June 1982)**. Dead: **255** British, **649** Argentines, 3 islanders.
- **Results:** Galtieri fell and **democracy** returned to Argentina (1983); Thatcher's popularity soared ("**Falklands factor**", 1983 landslide); relations with Argentina broken until **1990**; the dispute continues (99.8 per cent of islanders voted to stay British in **2013**).

In one line: a short, decisive war that restored British rule, toppled Argentina's junta and secured Thatcher's dominance.

John Major's Foreign Policy (1990–1997)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q8(c) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: John Major's foreign policy

- **The Gulf War (1991):** about **45,000** British troops in the US-led coalition that liberated **Kuwait**; Major proposed **safe havens** for the Kurds in northern Iraq and supported the no-fly zones.
- **Europe:** aimed to put Britain "**at the very heart of Europe**"; at **Maastricht (1991)** won opt-outs from the **single currency** and the **Social Chapter**, and the principle of **subsidiarity**; **Black Wednesday (1992)** forced Britain out of the ERM; party divisions and the **beef war** (BSE, 1996) weakened his European policy.
- **The Balkans:** British troops in the UN force (**UNPROFOR**) in **Bosnia (1992–95)**; criticised for caution (opposing arms for the Bosnians) until **Dayton (1995)**.
- **Northern Ireland:** the **Downing Street Declaration (December 1993)** with Albert Reynolds; the **IRA ceasefire (August 1994)** — foundations of the Good Friday Agreement.
- **The USA:** close with George H. W. Bush; tensions with **Bill Clinton** over Bosnia and Gerry Adams's visa (1994).
- **After the Cold War:** support for **Yeltsin's** Russia; defence cuts; peacekeeping.
- **Hong Kong:** Chris Patten's democratic reforms angered China; handover prepared for **1 July 1997**.

In one line: a cautious, constructive foreign policy — successful in the Gulf and Northern Ireland, constrained by Europe and Bosnia.

Part Two — The Past MCQs, Solved

CSS 2024 · MCQ 9

Who succeeded Margaret Thatcher as Prime Minister?

(A) Cullodena Newcomen	(B) James Callaghan	(C) Thomas Cuddodin	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: D. None of these — John Major

John Major succeeded Margaret Thatcher on 28 November 1990 after winning the Conservative leadership election. The names in the options are not real Prime Ministers (and Callaghan preceded Thatcher), so the key is "None of these".

CSS 2025 · MCQ 14

Which Prime Minister is most closely associated with large-scale privatisation of British industries?

(A) Margaret Thatcher	(B) Tony Blair	(C) John Major	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: A. Margaret Thatcher

Margaret Thatcher is the Prime Minister most associated with privatisation — British Telecom (1984), British Gas (1986), British Airways (1987), water (1989), electricity (1990).

CSS 2025 · MCQ 19

Which group led the major 1984–85 industrial action?

(A) Miners	(B) Dockworkers	(C) Train drivers	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: A. Miners

The great strike of **1984–85** was led by the **miners** (the NUM under Arthur Scargill) against pit closures; it ended in defeat in March 1985.

CSS 2026 · MCQ 10

Britain's first female Prime Minister belonged to which party?

(A) Liberal	(B) Labour	(C) Conservative	(D) None of these
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REMEMBER · Answer: C. Conservative

Britain's first woman Prime Minister, **Margaret Thatcher**, led the **Conservative** Party.

Part Three — Five Predicted Questions, with Outlines

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Why these five

They cover parts of syllabus Head XIV **not yet set** as full questions.

Predicted 1 · "Discuss the causes, course and consequences of the miners' strike of 1984–85."

- **Causes:** pit closures; Thatcher's aim to break union power; Scargill's politics; memories of 1972–74.
- **Course:** no national ballot; Nottinghamshire worked on; Orgreave; policing; hardship; the NCB's coal stocks.
- **Consequences:** defeat; closures; the end of union power; ruined communities; the Union of Democratic Mineworkers.

Predicted 2 · "Why did Margaret Thatcher fall from power in 1990?"

- **Poll tax** and riots; **economic problems** (inflation, interest rates); **Europe** (Lawson, Howe); her **style**; **Heseltine's** challenge; cabinet advice; her resignation.

Predicted 3 · "Assess Thatcher's foreign policy, with reference to the USA, the Soviet Union and Europe."

- **USA:** Reagan; cruise missiles; Libya; Grenada. **USSR:** the Iron Lady; Gorbachev; the end of the Cold War. **Europe:** the rebate; the single market; Bruges. **Others:** Falklands; Hong Kong; South Africa.

Predicted 4 · "Trace the Northern Ireland peace process from 1979 to 1998."

- Hunger strikes 1981; Brighton 1984; Anglo-Irish Agreement 1985; Downing Street Declaration 1993; ceasefire 1994; Mitchell principles; Good Friday Agreement 1998.

Predicted 5 · "How far did Thatcherism end the post-war consensus?"

- **The consensus:** welfare state, full employment, mixed economy, union partnership.
- **What changed:** monetarism (not full employment); privatisation; union laws; tax.
- **What survived:** the NHS; the welfare state (spending grew); New Labour's acceptance of her changes.
- **Verdict:** ended the economic consensus; created a new one.